GAP ANALYSIS · BUILD-AGENT HANDOFF · 2026-09-16

Can an agent prepare a form and get the errors?

https://github.com/SimonBarnett/agentic_fomprep
HEAD `f50391232ff6abdfc5ba4c9e52c814d337cbedaf` — idle-before-restore + company pin. Jobs: (1) named Form Prep on DEV (2) return compile errors to the agent.

Job 1 is proven once, by a human-supervised headed browser on DEV1, not by an unattended agent. Job 2 copies files and writes a one-line stub into result.errors[]. The agent does not get a parsed error list. si-web-state.json is currently expired — the next Prepare-Forms -SkipCli will refuse before park.

0. Score

Job	Today	Unattended agent?
1. Prepare a named form	Yes, once: ZCLA_PARTLONGDESC 101883 UPD=N lastprep 0→20359477 executor=web park 4/4	No — headed Chromium + live Si cookies + DEV1 desktop
2. Get errors for that form	Partial: copies e*msg, prep.err, errors-report.html; result.errors text is first emsg line or “captured”	No useful payload — pointers not lines

1. Job 1 — prepare a form: what works

- Public contract exists: Prepare-Forms -Names X -Environment DEV. Success = EXECPREPLOCK UPD=N AND LASTPREPDATE advanced (bigint). UI is not the signal.
- Park / restore / mutex / DEV freeze / AllUnprepared refuse are in place. AT4 5/5 and AT7 no-park are logged.
- Web path is pinned: Form Preparation tile, Select Company “D - Clarkson Evans Live” (= DEV base/system), Unprepared Forms, Errors Report. Frames + popup handled.
- CLI path is a documented no-op on this box (winrun exit 0, lastprep unchanged). Wrapper defaults SkipCli. Correct — do not treat CLI as prepare.

2. Job 1 — gaps that stop an agent

Gap	Sev	Why the agent dies	Close with
G1 session	P0	last-dev-run: si-web-state expired (login page). Probe/AT7 fail closed — good — but then nothing prepares.	Human recapture via tools/Save-WebStorageState.ps1. Agent cannot log in (2FA/interactive). Need a refresh playbook + TTL alarm.
G2 desktop	P0	formprep.mjs and session-probe are headless:false. Disconnected RDP / session 0 = no tile.	README already should say supervised desktop. Agent host = unlocked DEV1 console, or stop claiming unattended.
G3 no tool surface	P1	No MCP / HTTP. Agent must shell powershell -File src\Prepare-Forms.ps1 on DEV1 with Bypass.	Thin wrapper: Prepare-Forms.ps1 already is the API. Document the one command + result.json path. Do not build a second executor.
G4 isolation leak	P1	P0-BG wait added; one-name run still moved sibling lastprep 20359477→20359498. Wait timed out and restored anyway.	On timeout: do not restore until PID dead, or fail exit 3 and leave park OPEN for RepairOpenParks. Never “restore anyway”.
G5 estate after failed run	P1	DESC left UPD=Y lastprep 20359498 after expired session. Agent must WhatIf first.	WhatIf then prepare. Never assume trio is N.
G6 name cap	OK	1–10 names, no AllUnprepared. Fine for an agent.	Keep.

3. Job 2 — get errors: what exists

Get-PrepErrors.ps1 runs after CLI/web. It copies C:\Priority\tmp\e*msg (newest only), C:\Priority\tmp\prep.err, and capture/errors-report.html if Playwright saved the tab. Each becomes one result.errors[] row. Schema allows source emsg | prep.err | errors-report | modal | execpreplock | hook.

That is a capture pipeline, not an error API. On the proven web run, web-result.json had dialogs=[] and progressSeen=false; the HTML path is a file on DEV1, not lines in result.json.

4. Job 2 — gaps

Gap	Sev	What the agent actually sees	Close with
E1 no parse	P0	errors[].text is the first nonempty emsg line, or the literals “prep.err captured” / “Errors Report captured”. Not the compile errors.	Parse emsg/prep.err into lines. Each line → {source, formHint, code?, text}. Cap 200 lines. Put the rest in capture/ only.
E2 HTML not scraped	P0	errors-report.html is page.content() (often chrome/frameset). Grid cells never become JSON.	After clicking Errors Report, scrape table rows (frame-aware) into errors-report.jsonl before close.
E3 wrong file	P1	Get-LatestEmsg = newest e*msg in tmp. A previous user or a sibling prep wins.	Prefer files touched after startedAt. Stamp runId into capture/. Ignore emsg older than startedAt.
E4 severity lie	P1	If the form name appears anywhere in emsg/HTML, severity becomes Blocker and Complete-ResultObject can set ok=false even when UPD=N / lastprep moved.	Name mention = Warning unless the line matches compile-fail patterns. ok remains SQL-gated.
E5 not off-box	P1	Files live under C:\Priority\tmp\agent-formprep\<runId>\. A Grok/agent session not on DEV1 cannot read them.	Always write result.json there AND print its path. Optional: copy errors[] only (no HTML) to the repo-adjacent run log. Never commit HTML/cookies.
E6 no read-only command	P2	Agent cannot ask “what failed last night?” without running Prepare-Forms again.	Add Get-LastFormPrepResult.ps1 -RunId (reads result.json + capture lines). No park.

5. Minimum agent loop (once G1 is green)

On an unlocked DEV1 desktop, with a fresh si-web-state.json:

```
powershell -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File src\Prepare-Forms.ps1 -Names ZCLA_PARTLONGDESC -Environment DEV -SkipCli -TimeoutMinutes 15
```

Then read C:\Priority\tmp\agent-formprep\<runId>\result.json. Trust prepared[] / stillUnprepared[] / restoreOk. Do not trust errors[].text until E1/E2 land. Screenshots and HTML are evidence for a human, not model context (too large, may contain session residue).

6. Build order (only what unblocks the two jobs)

- **A.** Recapture storageState (human). Add a 1-liner doctor: probe fail → exit 2 “recapture cookies”, no park.
- **B.** E1+E3: parse emsg/prep.err lines newer than startedAt into errors[].
- **C.** E2: scrape Errors Report rows to JSONL in the same run dir.
- **D.** E4: stop promoting name-mention to Blocker; keep ok = SQL rule.
- **E.** G4: Wait-FormPrepIdle timeout must not restore-anyway; exit 3 + OPEN park.
- **F.** E6 read-only last-result helper.
- **Forbidden:** AllUnprepared, SQL-flip UPD, headless-on without proof, new executor, committing storageState or HTML reports.

7. Disposition

An agent on DEV1 with a live desktop and fresh cookies can prepare one named form today. It cannot recover the session itself. It cannot yet “get errors” in a form a model can act on — only file crumbs and a first emsg line. Close A–D before asking any agent to fix a form from the output of Form Prep.

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